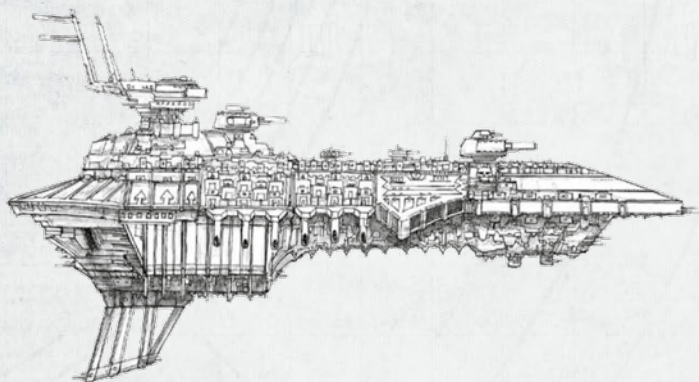


Famous Ships of the Gothic War: Merciless Death, Damnation's Fury, Fortress of Agony



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Battleship/12	20 cm	45°	4	5+	4
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED		FIREPOWER/STR	FIRE ARC
Port launch bays		Swiftdeaths: 30 cm Doomfires: 20 cm Dreadclaws: 30 cm		4 squadrons	–
Starboard launch bays		Swiftdeaths: 30 cm Doomfires: 20 cm Dreadclaws: 30 cm		4 squadrons	–
Port weapons battery		60 cm		6	Left
Starboard weapons battery		60 cm		6	Right
Dorsal lance battery		60 cm		3	Left/front/right
Prow lance battery		30 cm		4	Front
SPECIAL • May not use Come to New Heading special orders.					
OPTIONS • Can replace its prow lances with Strength 8 torpedoes at a cost of +10 points (like <i>The Damnation's Fury</i>).					

The Despoiler class battleships were developed as part of the Gareox Prerogative in the mid-36th millennium. A belief in the strength of attack craft as the ultimate weapons in space warfare pervaded the Battlefleet Tempestus and plans were made for fifteen Despoiler class battleships. However, as history shows, the true battleship was not outmoded by attack craft and the program was ended after the construction of just three vessels. The Despoilers originally saw little combat, being used on long-range patrols through largely uncontested systems. Roughly two hundred and fifty years after being laid down, the *Merciless Death* went missing whilst on extended tour through the Amerikon Sector. Thirty years later, it reappeared during the Banardi Conflict, surprising and destroying a convoy of sixteen unprotected Imperial transports en route to Banardi Prime. The ship was then involved in numerous engagements, each progressively nearer to the Eye of Terror, until it disappeared again in the early 39th millennium. Soon after its second disappearance, the other two Despoilers were also reported absent, after firing on friendly vessels and then escaping into the warp. With the advent of the Gothic War, rumours of the *Merciless Death's* exploits and sightings of its sister ships began afresh.

FLEET LISTS

Chaos Incursion Fleet List (pg. 226), Black Crusade Fleet List (pg. 228), The Sorcerous Fleet (pg. 230), The Plaguefleet (pg. 232), The Berzerker Fleet (pg. 234), The Pleasurefleet (pg. 236)